



Clockwise from extreme left: Ambar Ubud Bar at Mandapa, a Ritz Carlton Reserve; Ubud Shrub—foraged vegetables; Mignardise—Salted ginger caramel and wild mint meringue; Kintamani onion consomme at Kubu, Mandapa





MANDAPA, A RITZ CARLTON RESERVE, GIANYAR, INDONESIA

Just outside Ubud, 45 breezy minutes from Ngurah Rai Airport, the resort hums with the Ayung River's soft whispers, as frangipani perfumes the air and rice fields shimmer gold in the sunset's fiery finale. Here, luxury isn't just served, it's sculpted, and your personal Patih (think clairvoyant concierge) orchestrates everything from moonlit dinners in swaying paddies to spur of the moment jungle adventures. Yet, it's the food that truly takes centre stage. Mornings begin at Sawah Terrace with tropical fruits bursting like fireworks on your tongue, a silky noodle soup that feels like a Balinese hug, and bold Javanese coffee. On Sundays, the Royal Brunch transforms indulgence into symphony, slow roasted suckling pig, earthy rendang, and the world on a plate with surprises like tender ramen. Come evening, Kubu, the bamboo haven perched beside the river, entices with Chef Eka Sunarya's transformative tasting menu. Moringa risotto linger on your palate; beetroot tamarind sorbet zings with crisp brilliance. Chef Eka (read Bali's culinary oracle), champions hyper local ingredients sourced from within 100 kilometres. From farmers to fishermen, he builds community every bite, weaving sustainability into dishes that echo Bali's microclimates. The Tabanan heritage pig? It's not just food, it's a velvet symphony. Dining here isn't eating, it's cultural immersion.

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Must Do A farm visit with the Executive chef followed by a local lunch